an invasion of North Korea under the gung-ho leadership of General Douglas MacArthur.

included in one of my collections, I changed the title to "Green Patches." 10

On the nineteenth, I received the galley proofs of I, Robot, and on the twenty-fourth, the galley proofs of The Stars, like Dust—. This time there was no week spent on the loving caressing of the words. I adopted the principle I have used ever since. I got to it at once, went through it at a gallop that evening, and mailed it back the next day.

Then, too, I was writing a new short story. I had to. I felt guilty about having given The Stars, like Dust— and two short stories to Horace Gold. I had to balance it with something for Campbell.

On the weekend of October 14-15, 1950, I began a story called "Breeds There a Man?" and worked on it madly. It took me just two weeks to finish it, though it was 12,000 words long. I sent it to Campbell and he bought it without trouble. My conscience was at rest, especially since I thought it was a particularly good story. It was set in the near future and dealt with current problems—the need to work up a defense against the atom bomb—which is something I don't usually do. To be sure, I had an offbeat angle to it, with humanity representing an experimental culture being developed by intelligences (unspecified) somewhere off in space—a little like my thesis in "Death Sentence."

2 3

Toward the end of October, Gertrude had an idea. She enjoyed typing up I, Robot for me and it had made her feel more part of my work.

Since we couldn't have children (and by now, all efforts failing, we had both resigned ourselves to our status as a childless couple), why not arrange a life based on that?

Why shouldn't I get a dictating machine and dictate my stories? That might prove easier and faster than typing them. Then Gertrude would type them up. We would be a team.

I was fascinated by that. I looked into the matter and found that for $400 I could get an Audograph machine on which I could dictate stories onto small, thin, plastic records, which could then be replayed with a foot-pedal device for starting and stopping, so that, through an earphone, a typist could hear a